

Call for Expressions of Interest	
<i>Date of Issue:</i>	September 2026
<i>Expected Completion Date:</i>	May 2027
<i>Project Title:</i>	Detecting Bias in Recruitment
<i>Company:</i>	Beckford Consulting
Contact Details	
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Additional Info	
<i>Students must sign NDA:</i>	☒
<i>Project uses personal data:</i>	☒
<i>Custom hardware required:</i>	☐ If Applicable: Please provide details
<i>Relevant research areas (if applicable)¹:</i>	Cybernetics, AI, Ethical AI, Data processing
Project Background Information	
The Entelechy Engine (©John Beckford and Peter Dudley) is a learning machine that uses a proprietary cybernetic logic to highlight decision bias to the “human in the loop” system user. It does this by detecting bias in decisions arising from data sets (for example recruitment data). The engine uses a logic model with regulatory feedback loops and is designed specifically to work to high accuracy with small data sets on individual machines. A prototype of the Entelechy Engine has been built using Java and the group would have access to this, to prior prototypes as well as documentation on the engine.	

¹ An overview of different research areas in the school of computer science can be found [here](#).

Requirements	
The group is tasked with reviewing the challenge of bias in selection/recruitment, reviewing a logical model of the recruitment process, reviewing the existing prototype and either modifying or extending the existing Java prototype or building the Entelechy Engine from scratch using (justified) technology of their choice BUT adopting the core 'AI' logic of the existing prototype. This adoption is critical as the core logic differs from 'conventional' AI engines and a key requirement is to create a comparator to those conventions. The group will then aim to build an equivalent piece of software using more traditional AI methods (that are not cybernetic). Finally the group will conduct experiments comparing the performance (parameters to be defined) of the two versions and reflect on the ethical use of AI for purposes such as recruitment in the real world.	
Skills	
<i>Highly desirable:</i> Programming Knowledge of AI methods	<i>Desirable:</i> Conducting experiments
Submission / Award information	
<i>Date of Submission:</i>	September 2026
<i>Date of Pitch:</i>	October 2026
<i>Notification of award:</i>	October 2026

For further information on this proposal, the team representative should in the first instance e-mail the lead contact stated above at the e-mail address provided.